can basically get whatever products that the mass manufacturers of servers put out. We found the mass manufacturers weren't in line with what we needed and what social apps need," CEO Mark Zuckerberg said at the event.

By launching the Open Compute Project and sharing design specifications, he hoped to increase availability and demand for the specialised servers.

Dell will build servers based on those technical specifications, while Synnex will act as the overall vendor for the systems. The technology will power servers in the company's first custom-built data centre, in Oregon.

The new servers are, according to Facebook, 38 per cent more energy efficient than the ones the company has been buying and cost 24 per cent less than off-the-shelf products used to power its service.

Intel to power Android tablets?

Intel has been slightly late in entering the mobile devices (smartphones and tablets) market with chips from ARM dominating most of the products. However, sensing the change in consumer preferences from laptops and netbooks to mobile devices, Intel is reportedly developing a processor specifically for tablets.

Code-named Oak Trail, it will be an upgrade to Atom and would feature in tablets from the likes of Fujitsu, Acer, Lenovo, Cisco and Asus in Q3 2011. Intel is reportedly also helping manufacturers build hype around the new chipsets by offering a rebate of $10 per unit.

Intel might not be the first to enter Android tablets, but since it has a good relationship with Google, it might expect preferential treatment. Intel's Atom chipsets help run the set-top boxes of Google TV and even the Cr-48 laptops running on Google's Chrome OS.

However, it's not that the new family of chips from Intel would be Android-exclusive. It would also cater to tablets running on Windows 7 and MeeGo operating systems. Some of the early prototypes were on show earlier this year at the Consumer Electronics Show.

TI launches open source Web portal

Texas Instruments (TI) has launched a new website called Openlink.org, which aims to bring the company's mobile and embedded Wi-Fi and Bluetooth solutions to the open source developer community under the Openlink brand. Customers and developers targeting battery-powered Wi-Fi products can now use TI's OpenLink drivers, gaining native kernel benefits such as tested technologies, faster time-to-market, and simplified re-integration when upgrading from one kernel version to the next.

In addition to Wi-Fi, the OpenLink project includes native Linux solutions for Bluetooth and FM technologies, and will expand to support other technologies such as ANT, Bluetooth Low Energy and ZigBee. TI will also introduce additional low-power features to the kernel when possible.

"OpenLink marks TI's commitment to deliver cutting-edge wireless capabilities into the hands of Linux developers," said Oz Krakowski, open

World's first airborne smartphone

Aircell (not to be confused with the Indian mobile service provider, Aircel) has launched the Aircell Smartphone, a next-generation cabin handset designed specifically for business aircraft. This US-based firm pioneered broadband services for commercial and aviation industry purposes, back in the early 1990s. The intuitive, menu-driven features on Aircell's smartphone allow passengers to place and receive voice calls aboard business aircraft as easily and conveniently as they do with mobile phones on the ground. In addition, its flexible Android OS platform sets the stage for a nearly unlimited set of media features and functions in the future.

Measuring 9.6-cm (3.8 inch) diagonally, the Aircell Smartphone's colour touchscreen display is said to be the largest the aviation industry has ever seen in a telephony device. It even exceeds the size of most consumer smartphones on the market today.

The Aircell Smartphone will be backward-compatible with all Aircell Axxess communications systems currently in production, and will be available as a drop-in replacement for the company's prolific Aircell Axxess flush-mount handset.

It will also be fully compatible with the company's forthcoming Gogo Biz Voice service via the ATG 4000 and ATG 5000 systems. Shipments of the new Aircell Smartphone are scheduled to begin in late 2011 and pricing will be announced at that time.